Center Midfields Center

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Player counts

In this project, there are a total of 56 center center midfields considered, with

- 21 center midfields in 12 teams in the English FA Women's Super League
- 19 center midfields in 12 teams in the German Frauen Bundesliga
- 26 center midfields in 16 teams in the Spanish Liga F
- 17 center midfields in 10 teams in the Italian Serie A Women

Results

Results for 2 clusters

Breakdown of results by league

league	FA Women's Super League	Frauen Bundesliga	Liga F	Serie A Women
kmeans_2_cluster				
0	9	14	12	9
1	2	3	4	3

The split is very lopsided towards cluster 0, with the split close to 3 to 1 or even 4 to 1.

Breakdown of results by features

- Cluster 0 midfielders made more progressive passes and passes into opposition box, carried more into the final third, defended at more advanced locations, in particular blocking and pressing.
- On the other hand, cluster 1 midfielders shot closer to goal at higher quality per shot, while standing out for percentage of header passes and shots. They received more inside opposition box, and their receiving locations varied more.

Therefore, based on these results,

- Cluster 0 center midfielders can be seen as progressive distributor.
- Cluster 1 center midfielders can be seen as aerial and box arrival threats.

Results for 3 clusters

Breakdown of results by league

league	FA Women's Super League	Frauen Bundesliga	Liga F	Serie A Women
kmeans_3_cluster				
0	3	3	2	2
1	3	6	5	3
2	5	8	9	7

The number of players in cluster 2 was approximately the same as the total number of players in cluster 0 and cluster 1 for all leagues.

Comparing results for 2 clusters against 3 clusters

kmeans_3_cluster	0	1	2
kmeans_2_cluster			
0	10	6	28
1	0	11	1

It seems like k = 2 cluster 0 splits into k = 3 cluster 0 and 2, while k = 3 cluster 1 retains most of its members from k = 2 cluster 1. In addition, only 1 player from k = 2 cluster 1 did not land in k = 3 cluster 1.

Breakdown of results by features

- Cluster 1 midfielders passed and carried more backward, while stood out for header features like shooting and clearing. Their receipt positions varied more, while receipts inside the box also stood out. Their shots were closer to goal and of higher quality.
- While cluster 0 midfielders passed and carried more forward and progressive into the final third, where their passes were longer on average. Most of their positionings were higher up the pitch, including for receiving, dribbling, and most defensive attributes.
- Cluster 2 midfielders, on the other hand, involved in lower positions both when attacking and defending, while dribbling and receiving more centrally.

Hence, the following conclusions can be made:

- Similar to k = 2 cluster 1, k = 3 cluster 1 comprises of aerial/box arrival threats midfielders, which can be seen as deep aerial specialists. Whether these players can be defined as box to box midfielders need to depend on heat map of locations.
- Cluster 0 midfielders can be seen as progressive distributors and carriers, which can be seen as advanced playmakers.
- Cluster 2 can be seen as deep lying playmakers.

Breakdown of results by players

Findings and radar plots for each center midfielder are in their own files:

- Manuela Giugliano - AS Roma
- Sjoeke Nusken - Chelsea
- Melanie Leupolz - Chelsea
- Missy Bo Kearns - Liverpool
- Lena Oberdorf - VfL Wolfsburg

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Appendix

Radar plots for 2 clusters center midfields' averages

All leagues

Passing

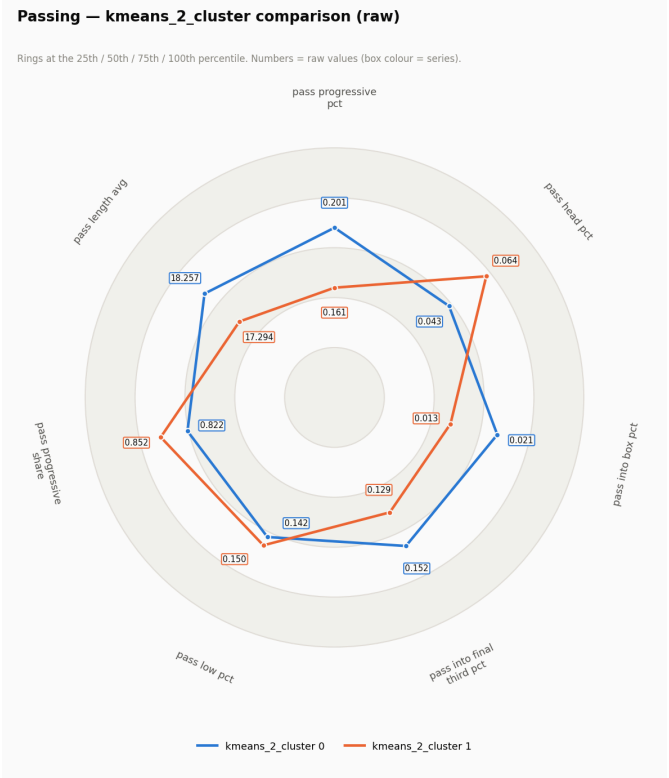


Figure 1: Center Midfields Center Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

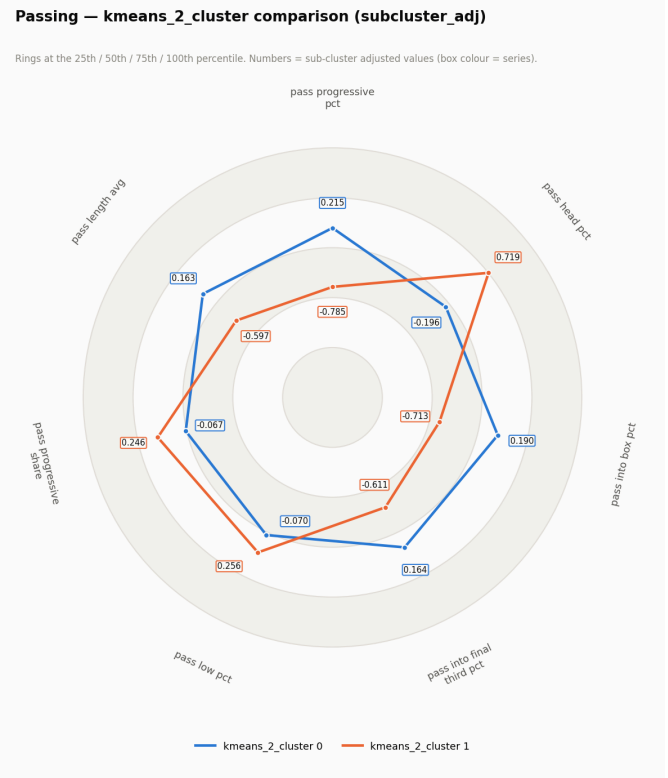


Figure 2: Center Midfields Center Passing — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

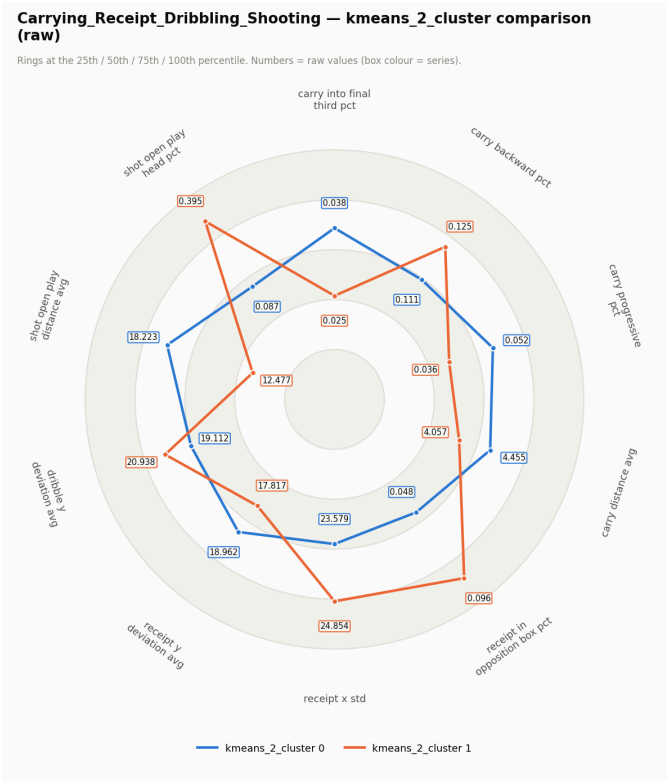


Figure 3: Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

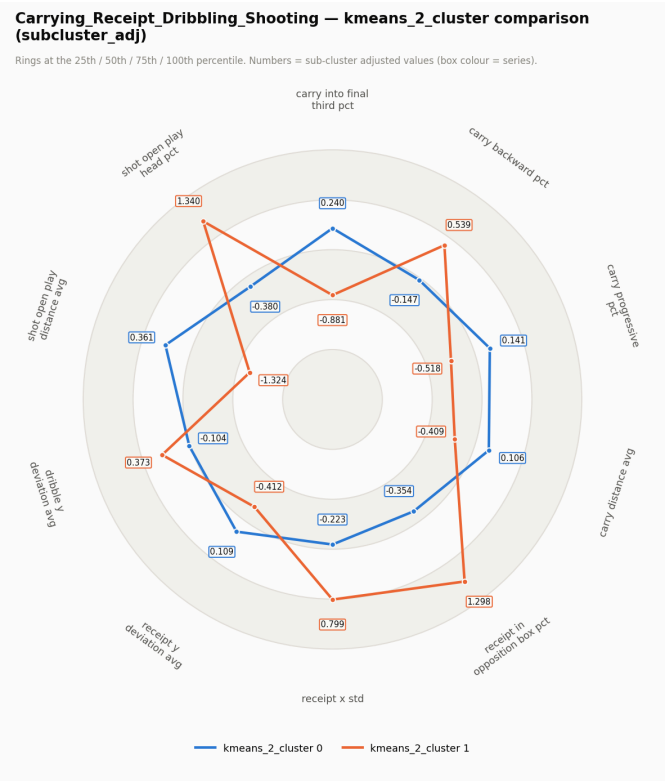


Figure 4: Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

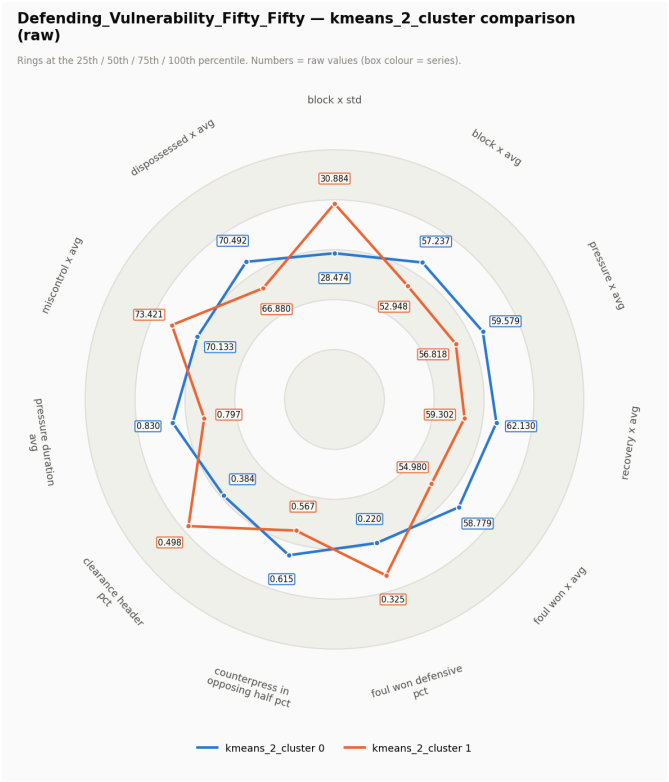


Figure 5: Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

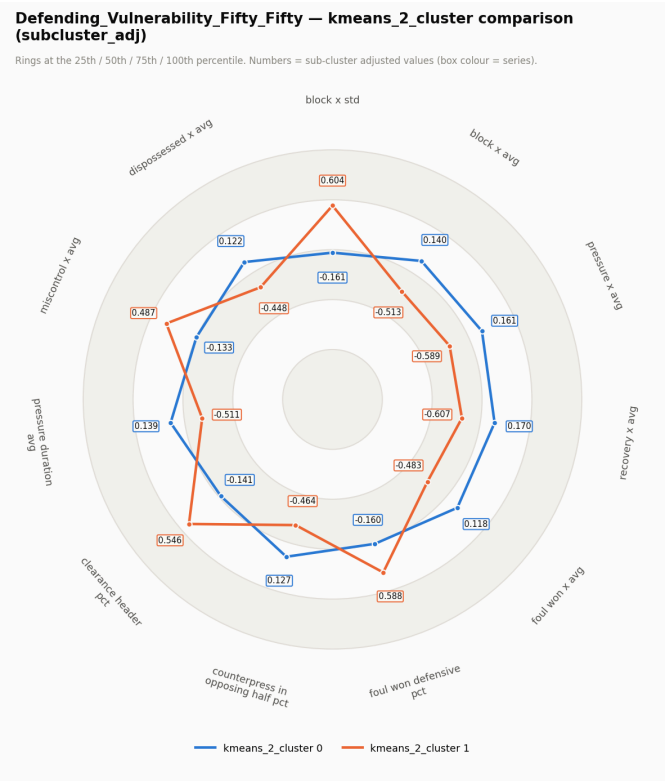


Figure 6: Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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FA Women's Super League

Passing

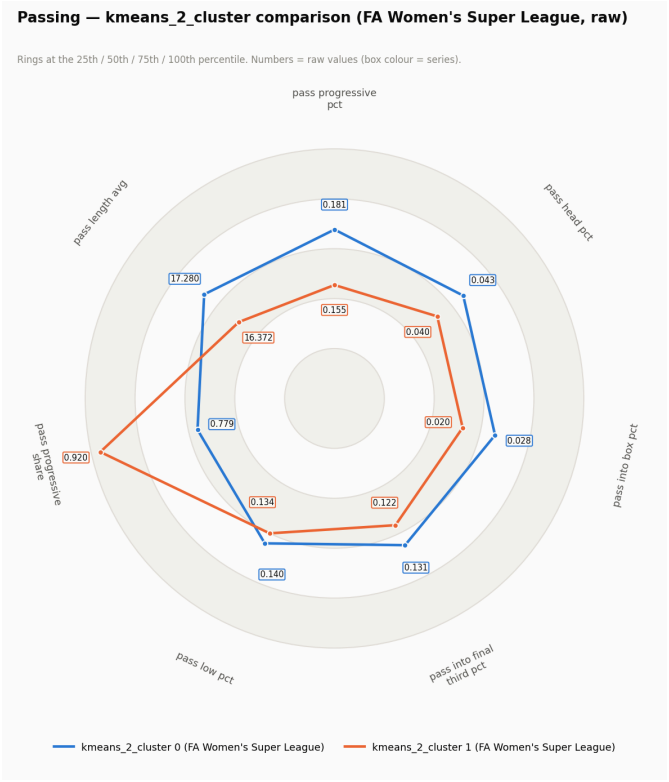


Figure 7: England Center Midfields Center Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

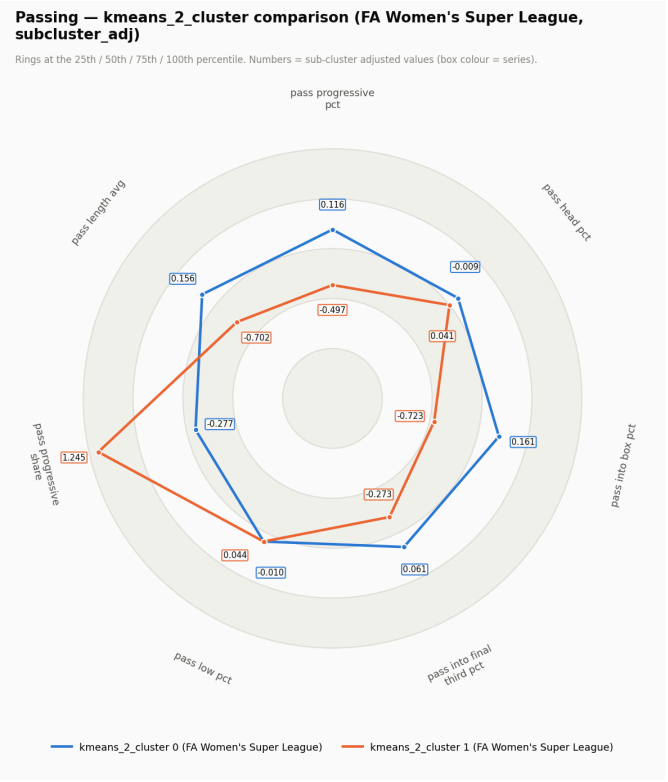


Figure 8: England Center Midfields Center Passing — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

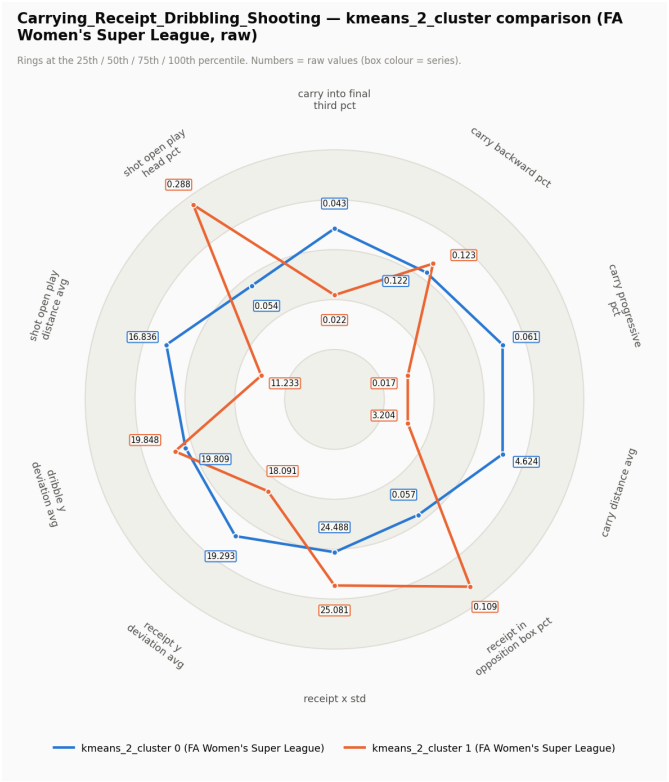


Figure 9: England Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

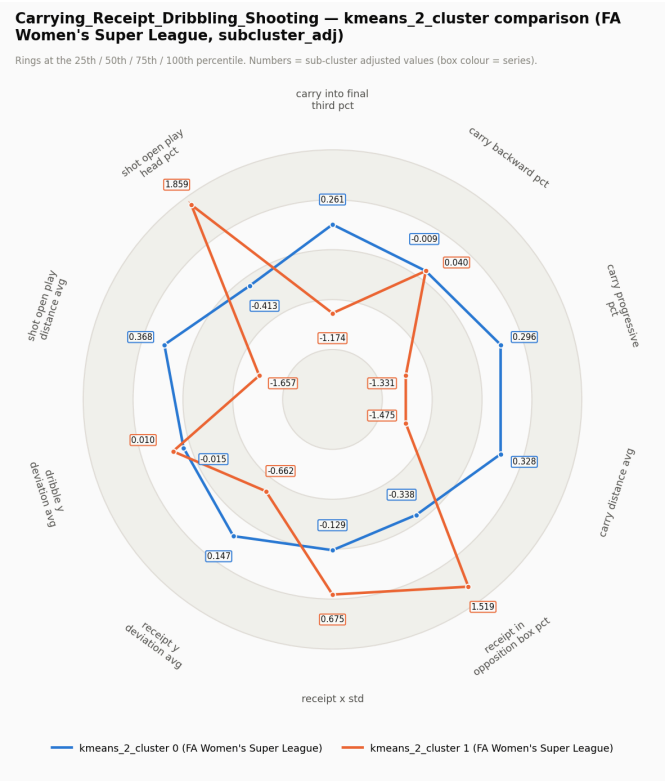


Figure 10: England Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

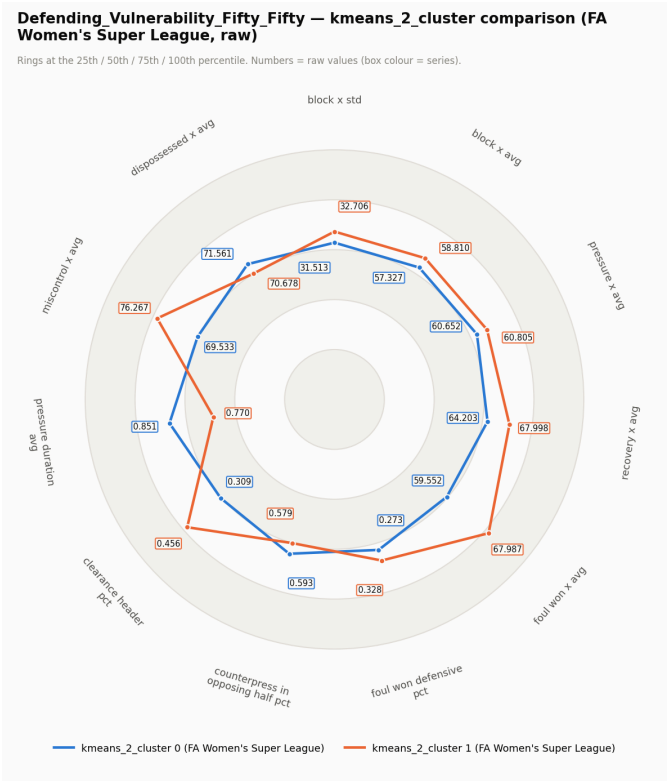


Figure 11: England Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

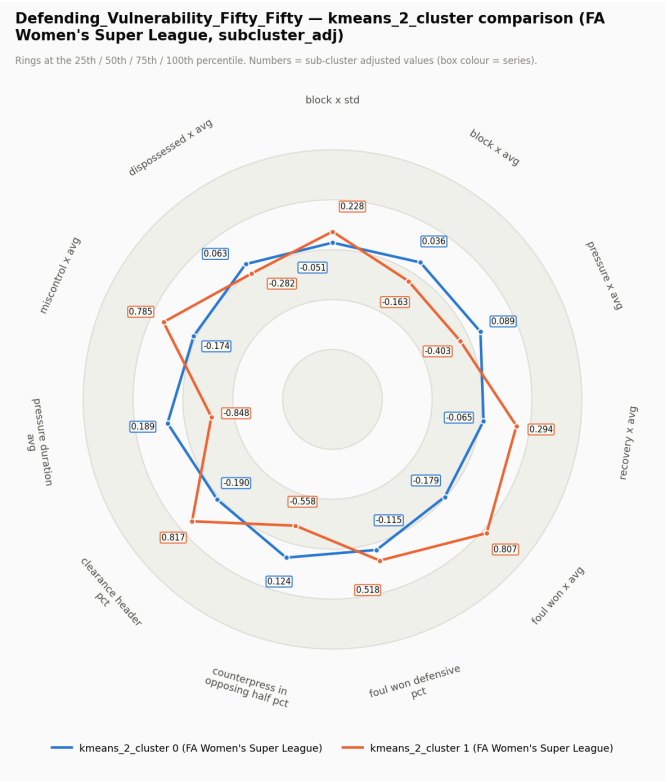


Figure 12: England Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Frauen Bundesliga

Passing

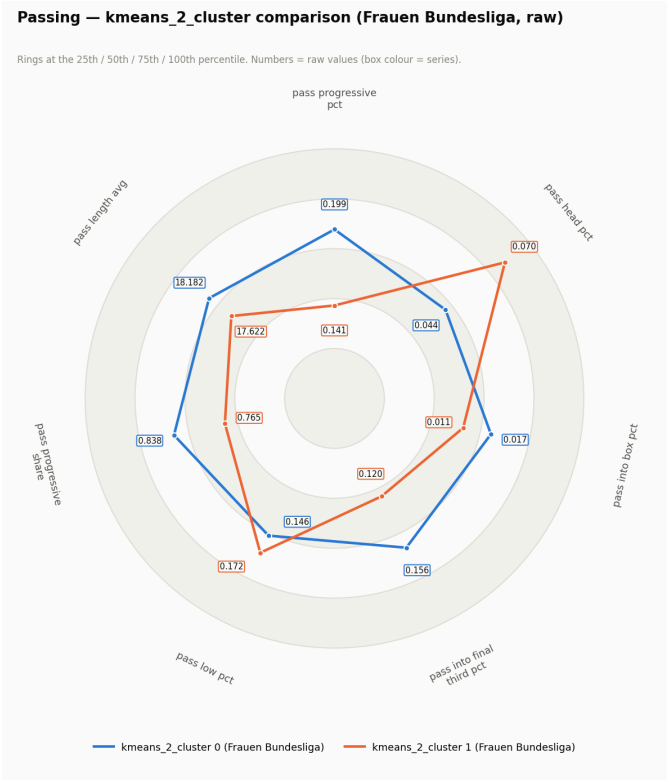


Figure 13: Germany Center Midfields Center Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

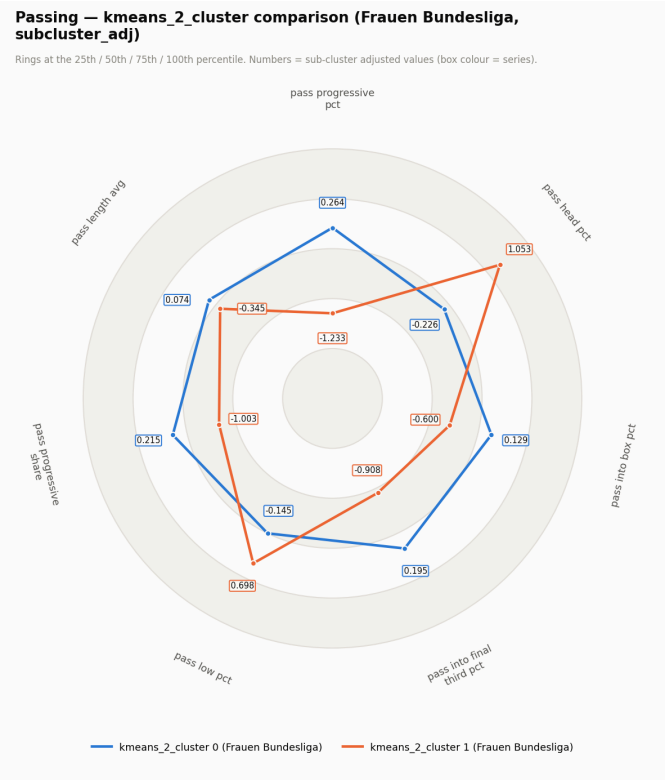


Figure 14: Germany Center Midfields Center Passing — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

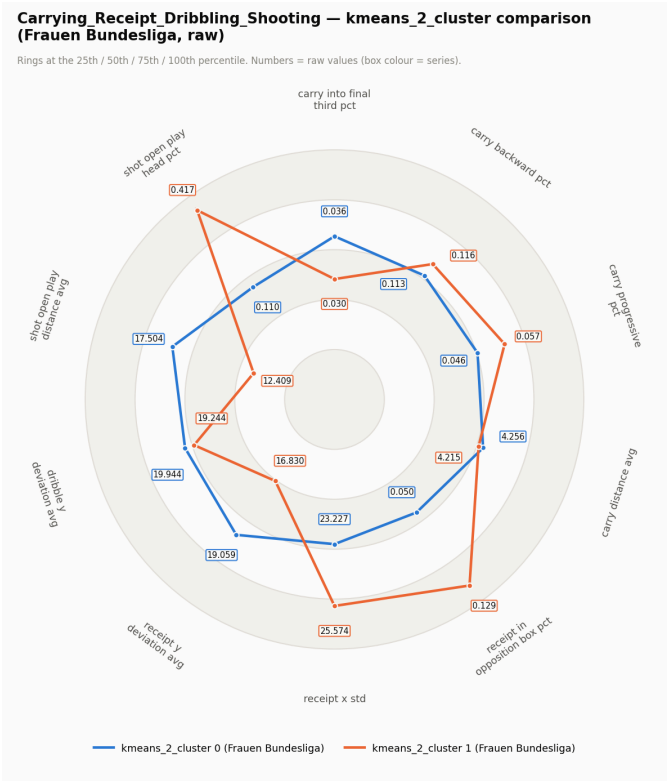


Figure 15: Germany Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

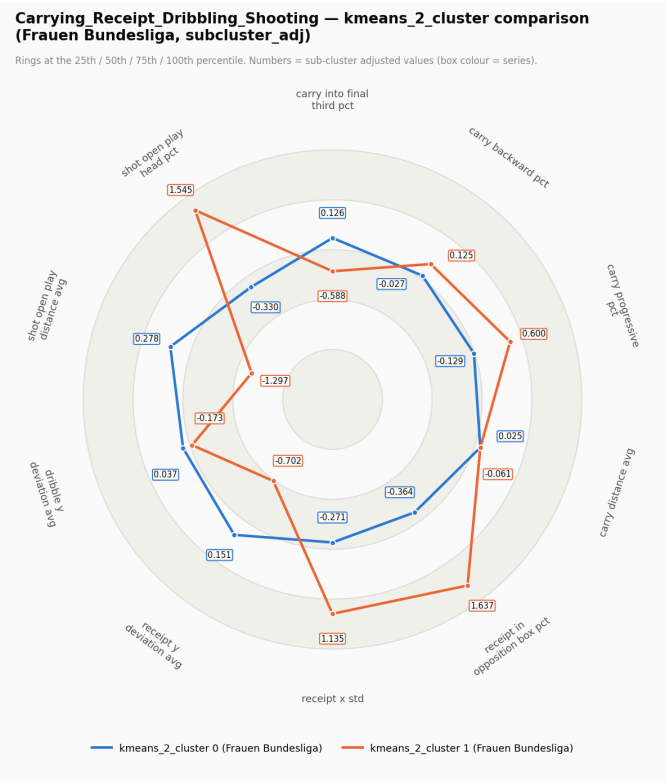


Figure 16: Germany Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

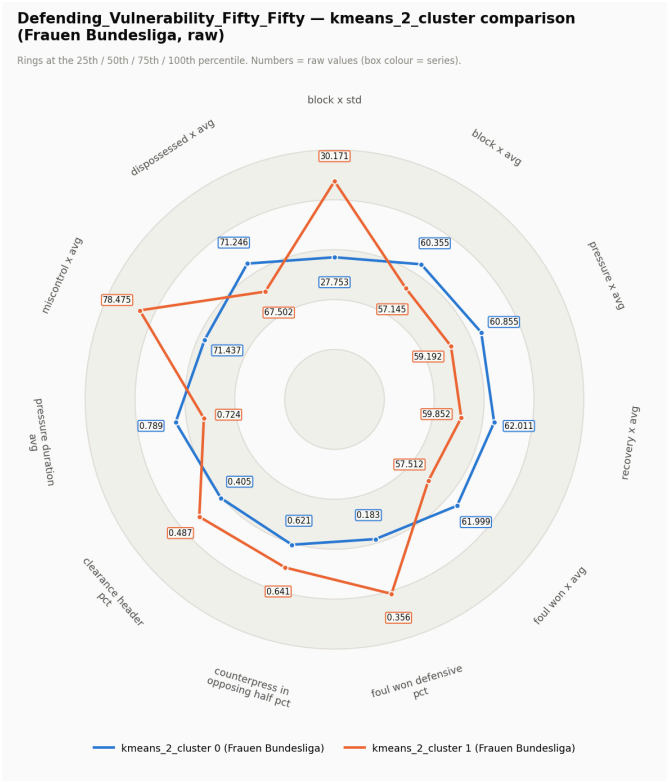


Figure 17: Germany Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

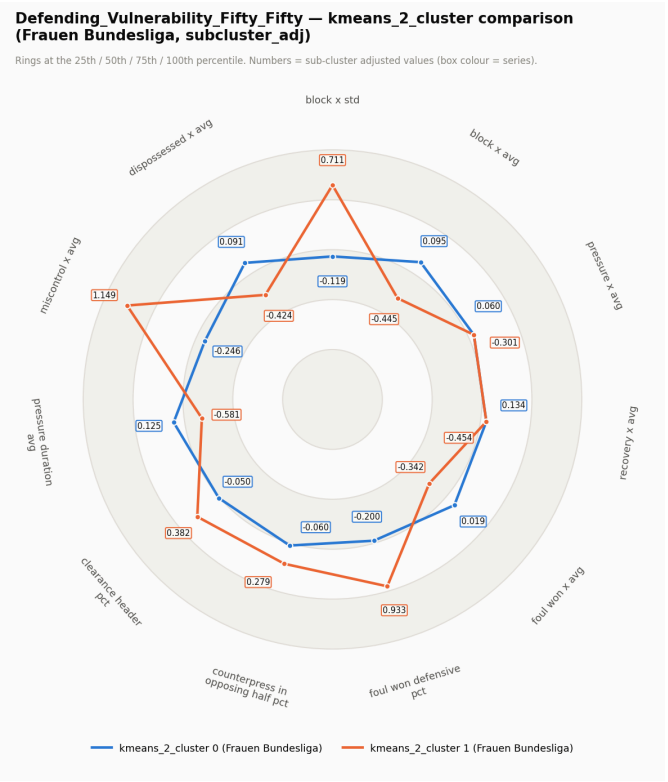


Figure 18: Germany Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Liga F

Passing

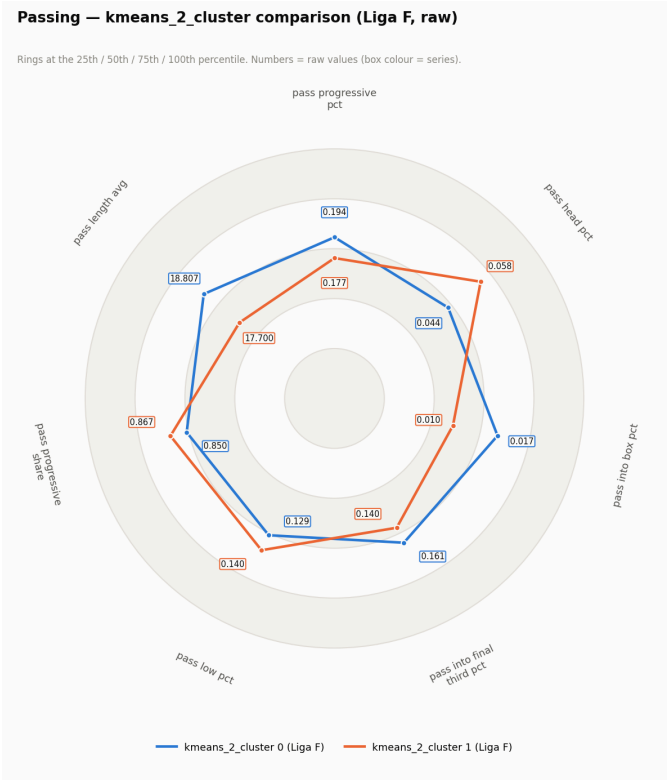


Figure 19: Spain Center Midfields Center Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

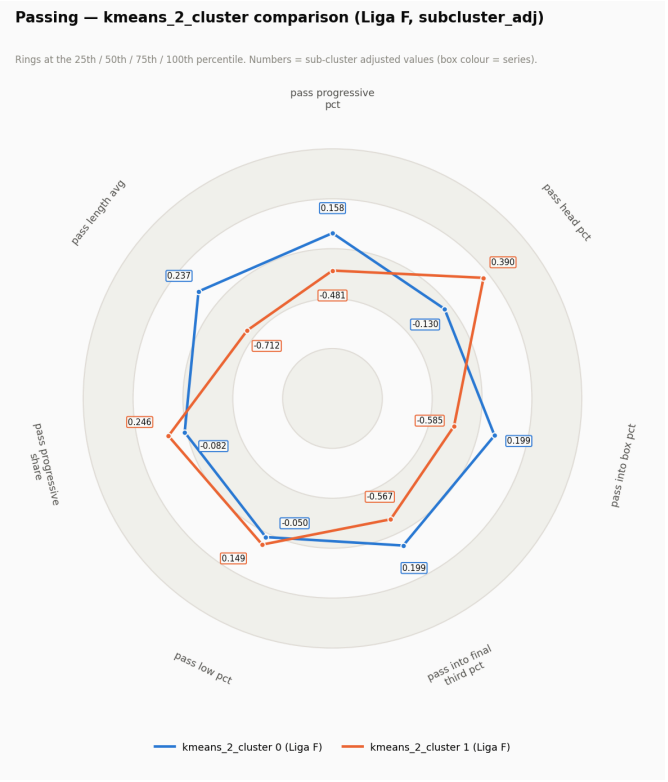


Figure 20: Spain Center Midfields Center Passing — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

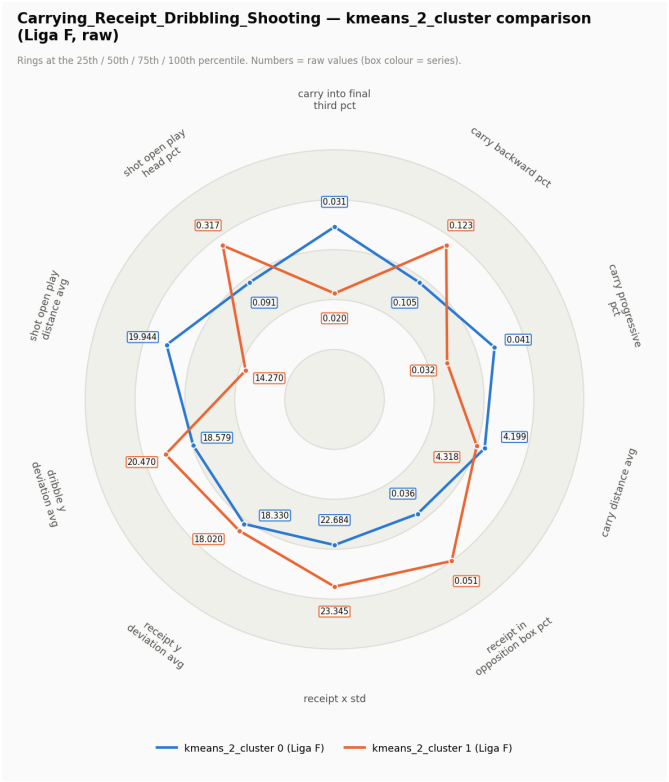


Figure 21: Spain Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

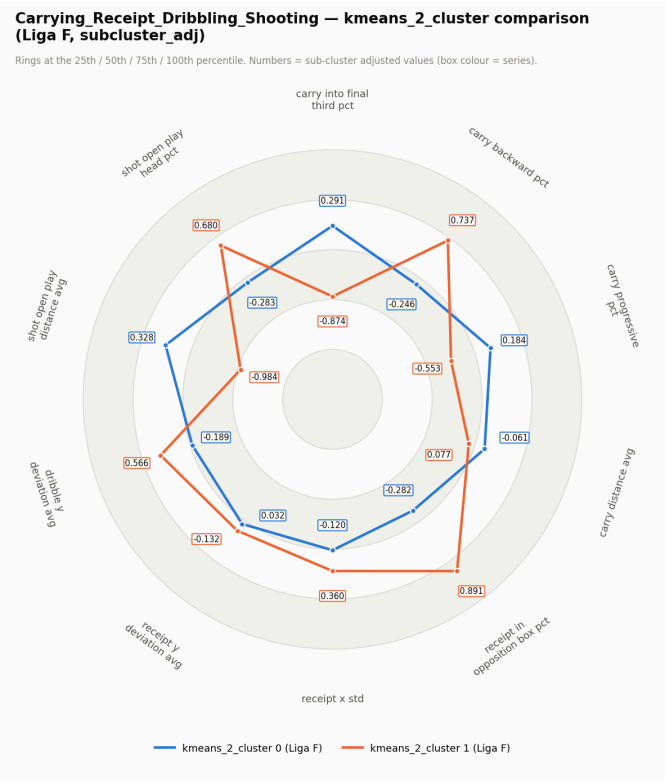


Figure 22: Spain Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

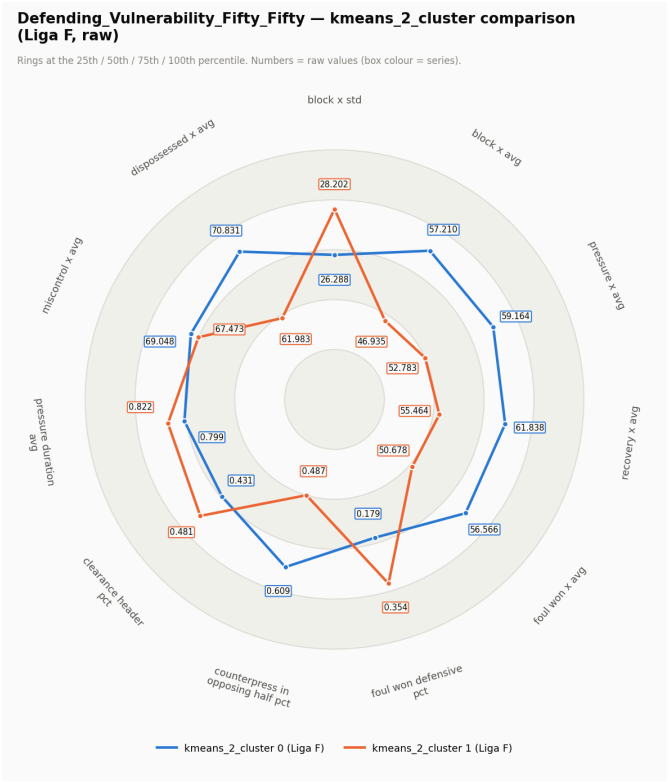


Figure 23: Spain Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

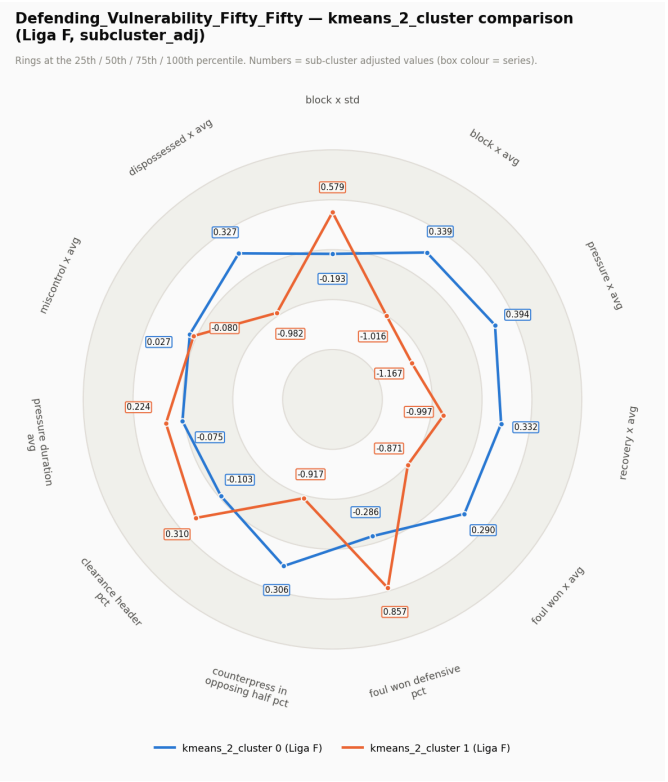


Figure 24: Spain Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Serie A Women

Passing

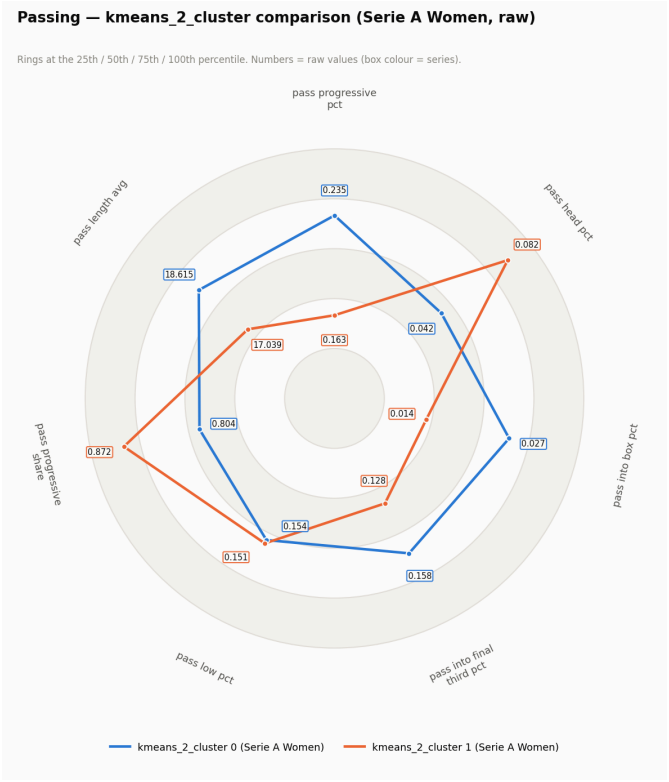


Figure 25: Italy Center Midfields Center Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

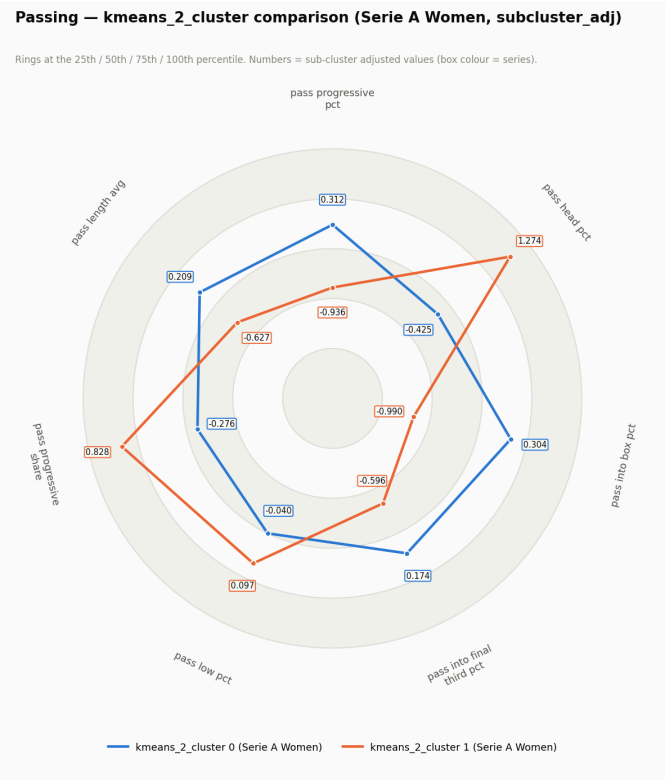


Figure 26: Italy Center Midfields Center Passing — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

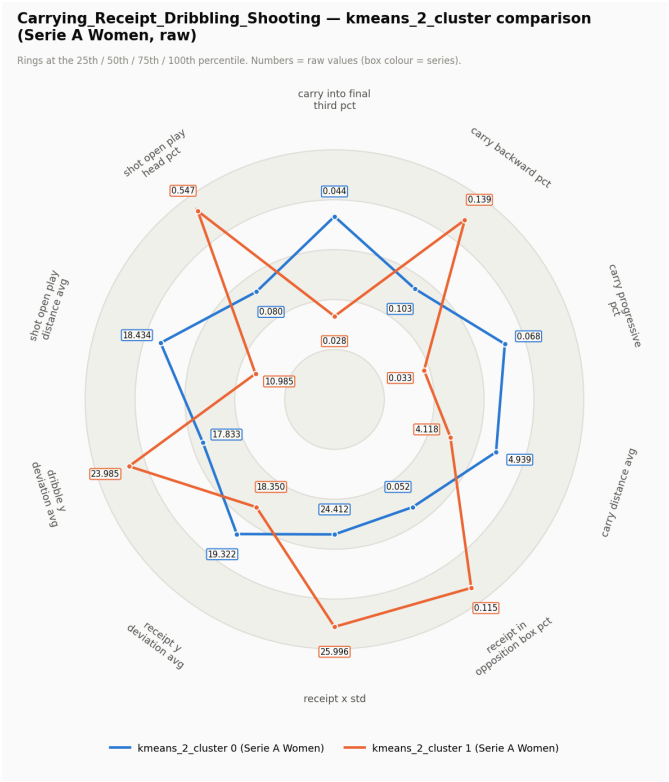


Figure 27: Italy Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

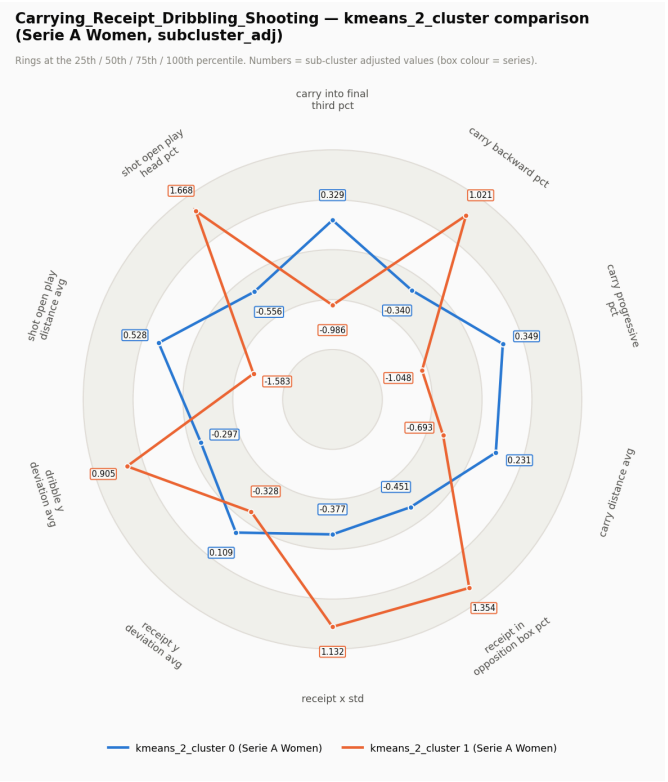


Figure 28: Italy Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

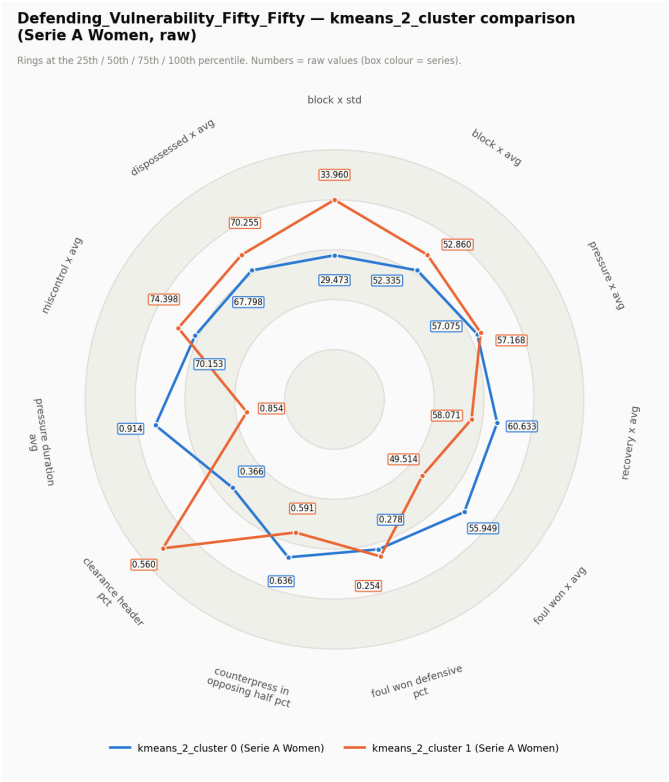


Figure 29: Italy Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

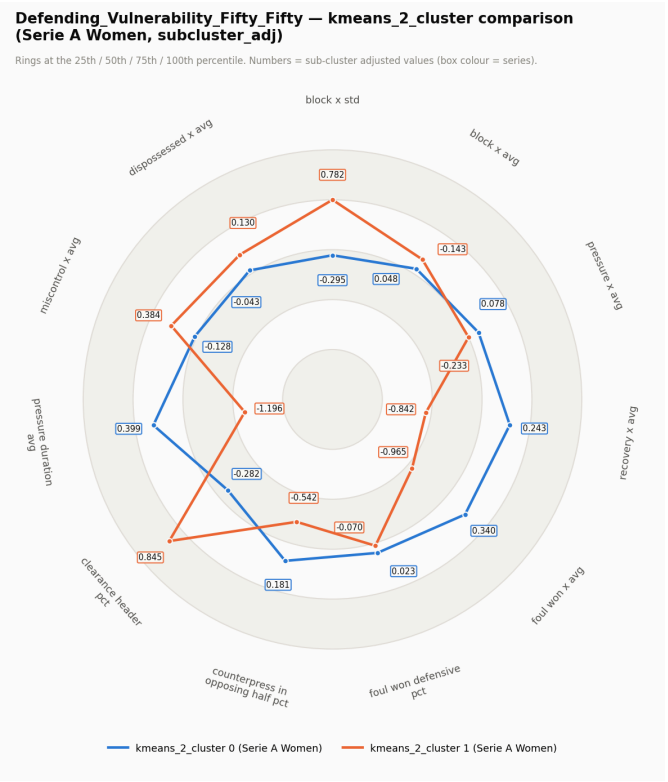


Figure 30: Italy Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 2 Clusters

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Radar plots for 3 clusters center midfields' averages

All leagues

Passing

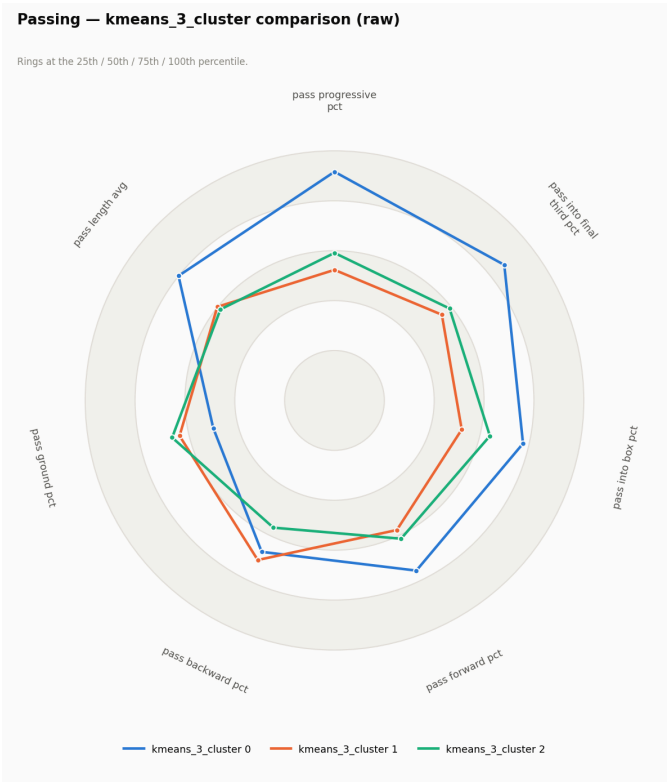


Figure 31: Center Midfields Center Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

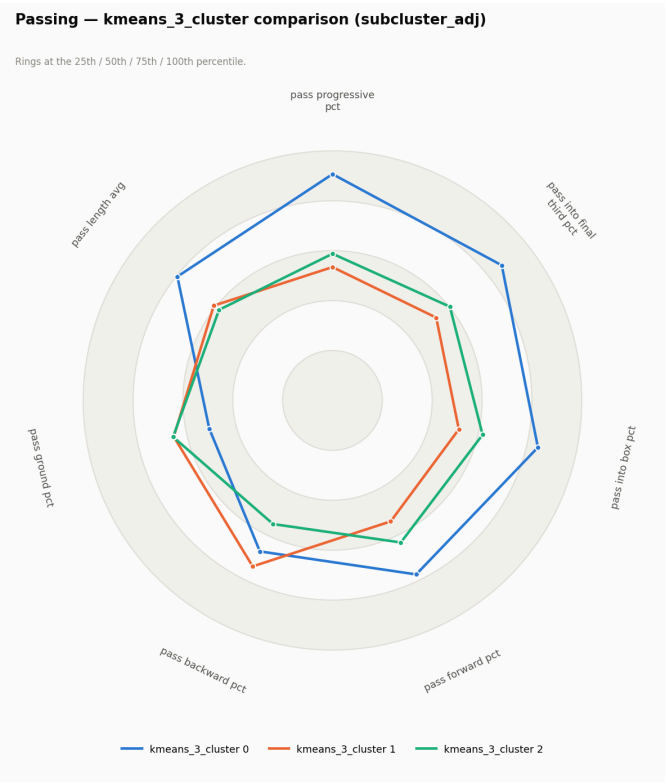


Figure 32: Center Midfields Center Passing — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

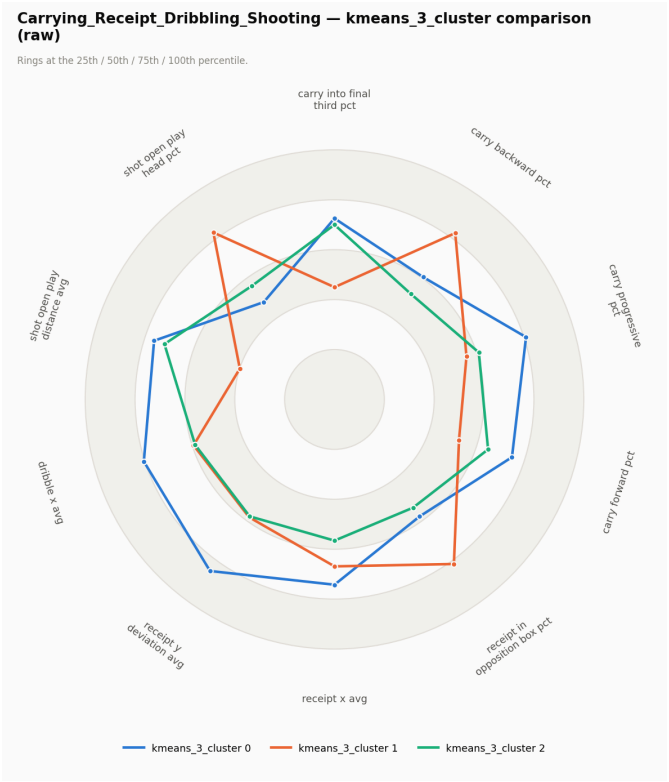


Figure 33: Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

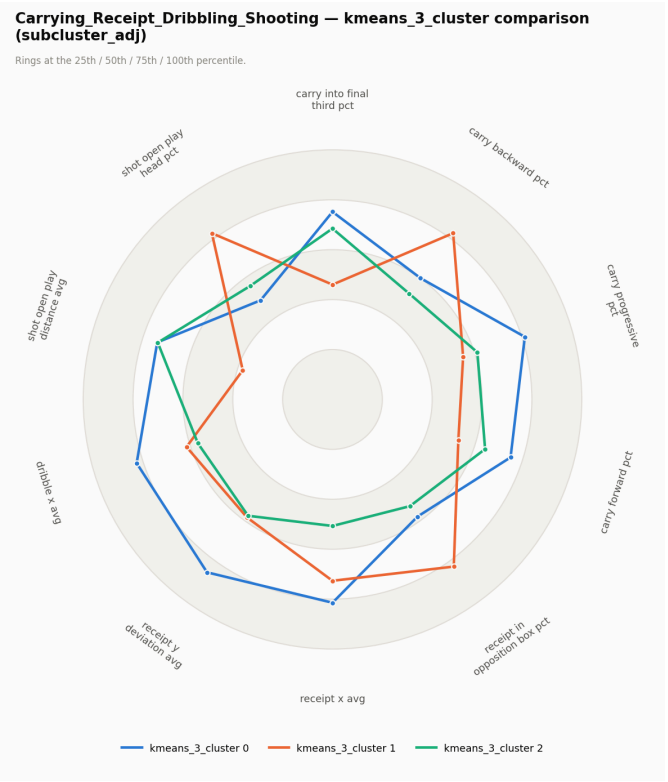


Figure 34: Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

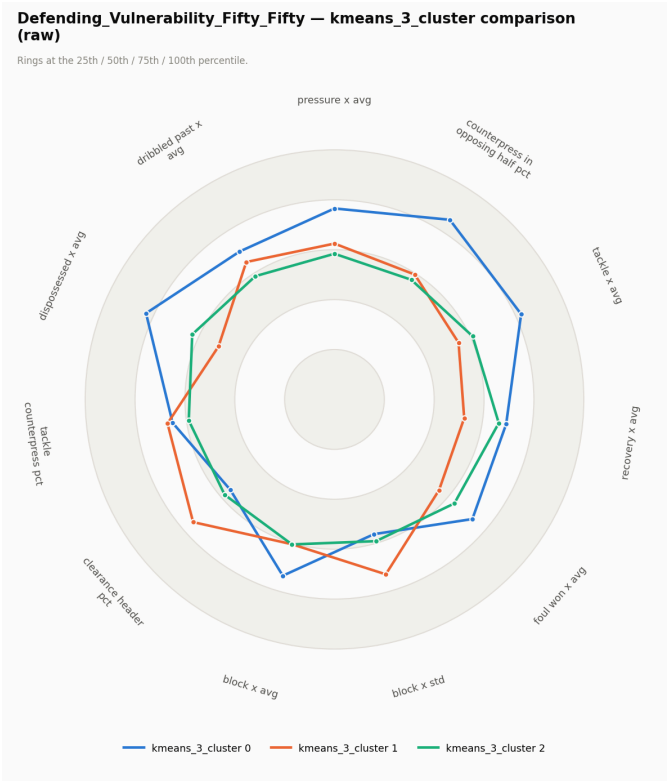


Figure 35: Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

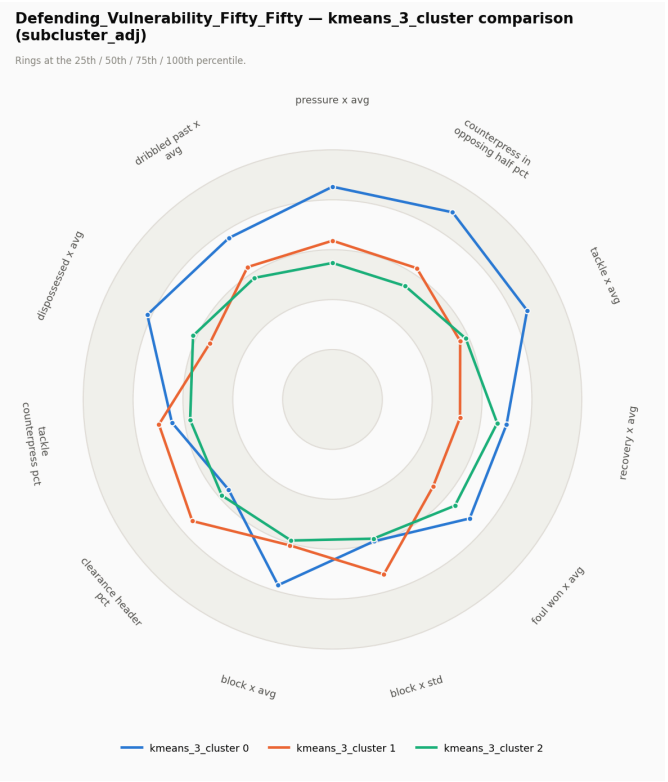


Figure 36: Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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FA Women's Super League

Passing

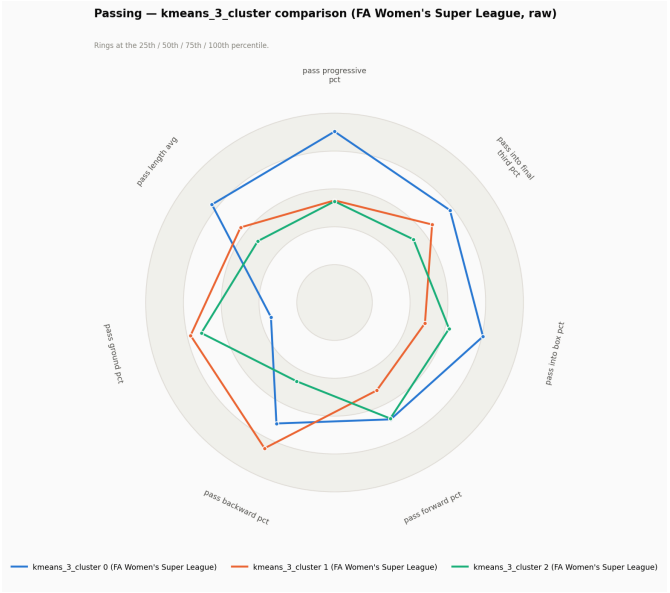


Figure 37: England Center Midfields Center Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

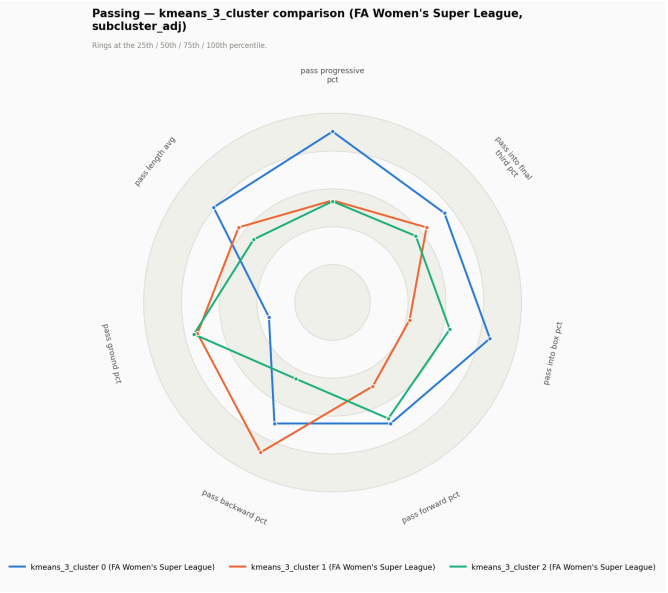


Figure 38: England Center Midfields Center Passing — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

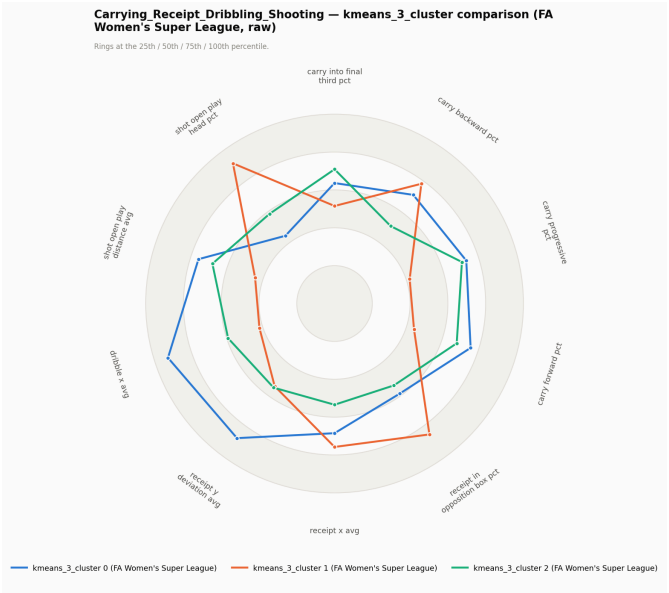


Figure 39: England Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

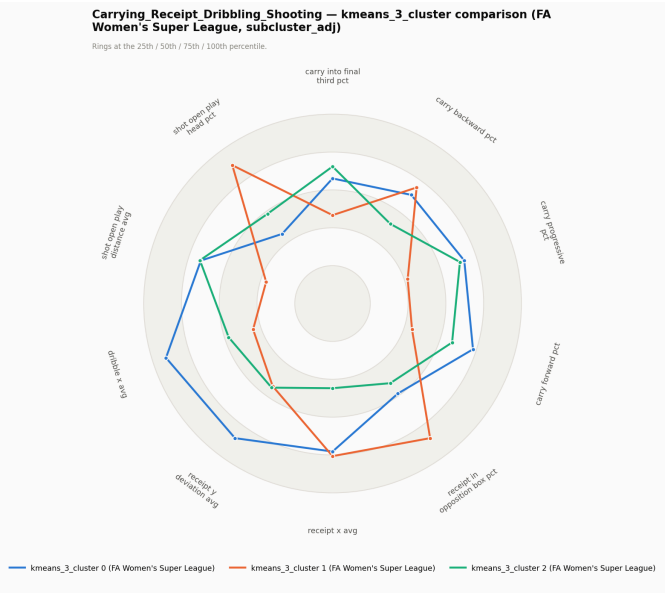


Figure 40: England Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

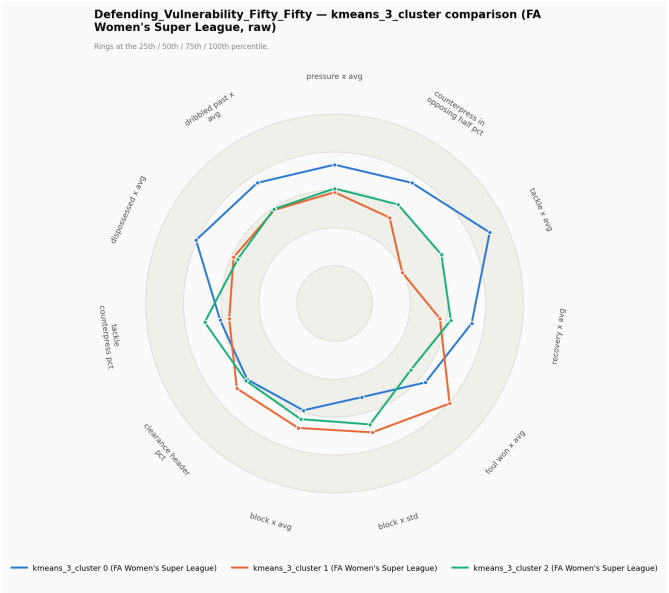


Figure 41: England Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

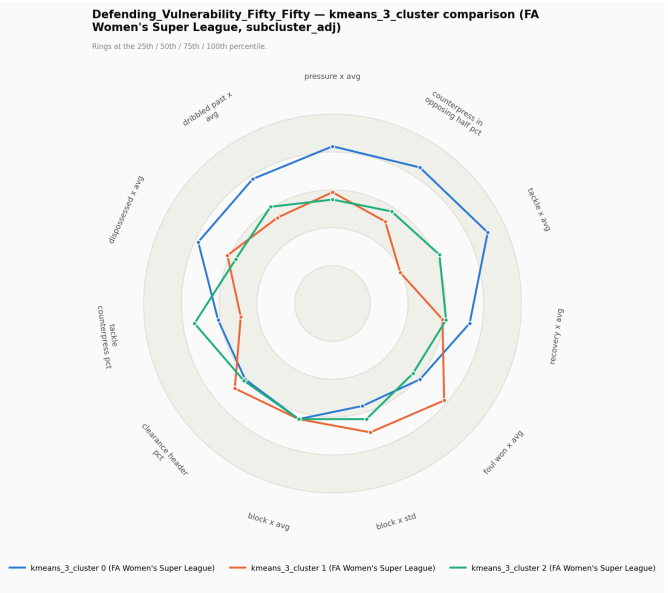


Figure 42: England Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Frauen Bundesliga

Passing

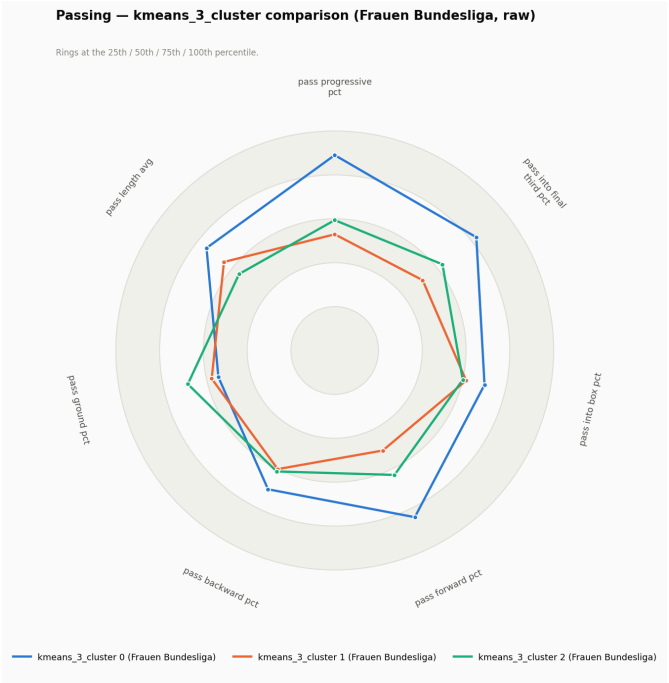


Figure 43: Germany Center Midfields Center Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

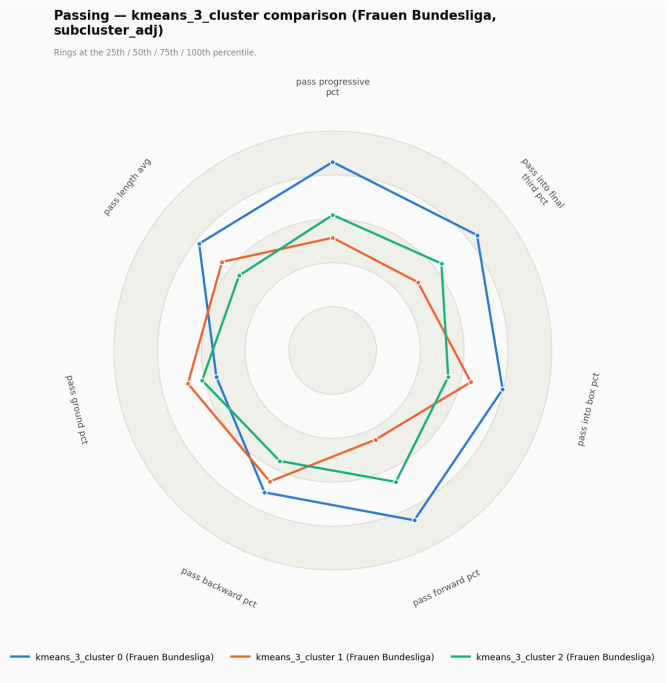


Figure 44: Germany Center Midfields Center Passing — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

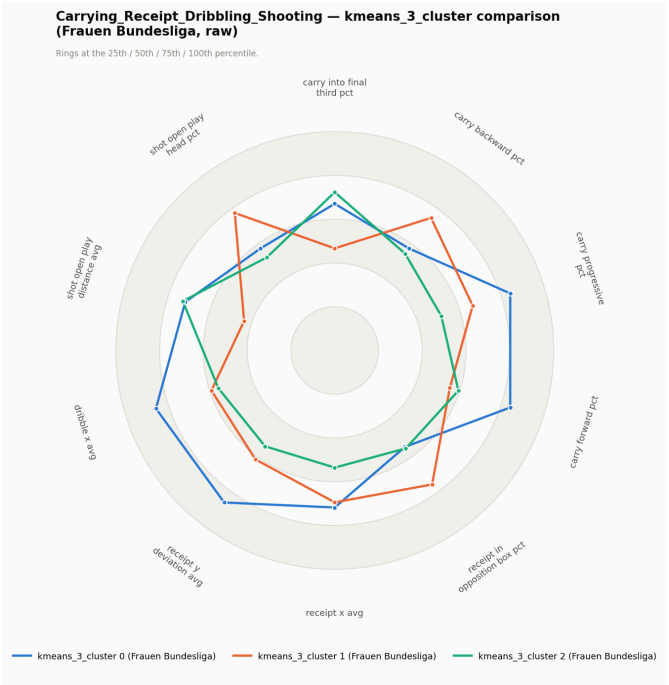


Figure 45: Germany Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

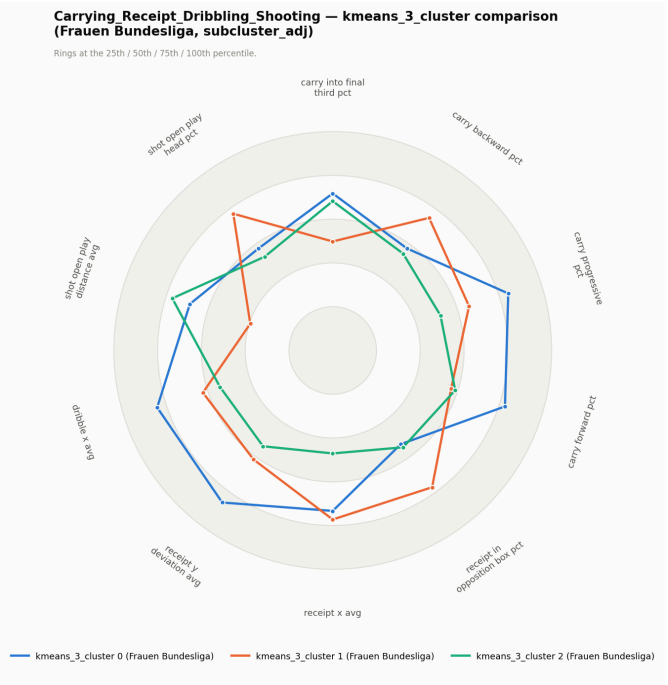


Figure 46: Germany Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

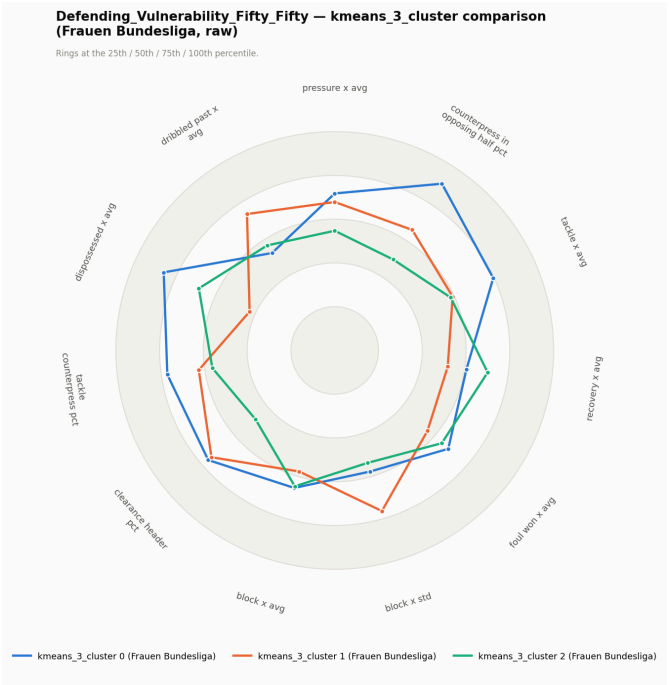


Figure 47: Germany Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

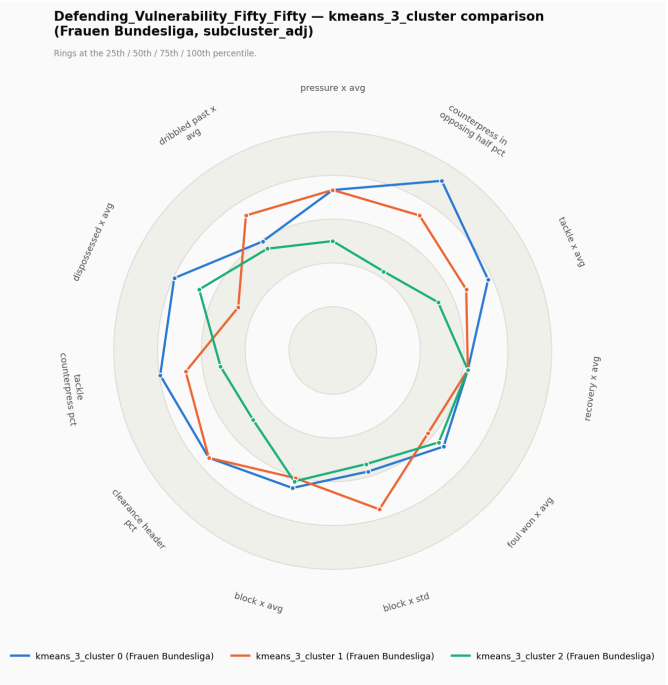


Figure 48: Germany Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Liga F

Passing

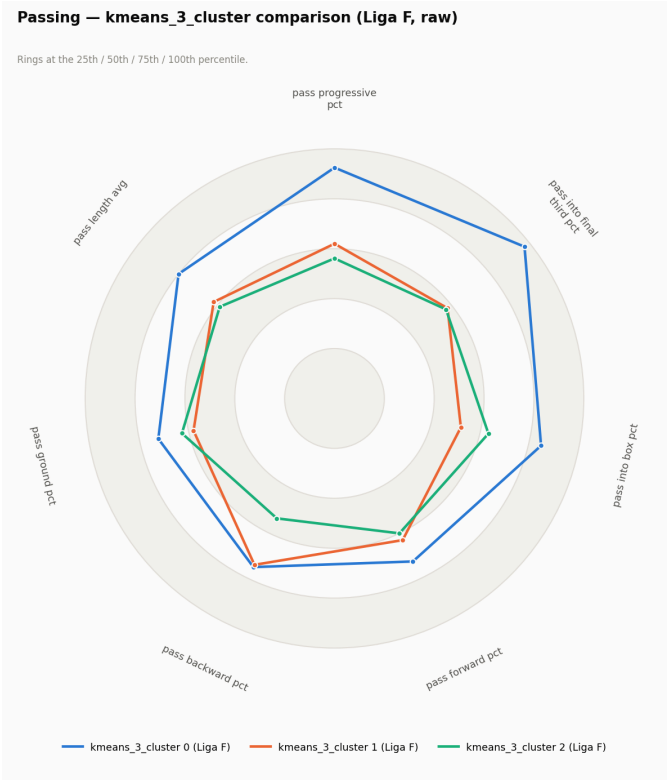


Figure 49: Spain Center Midfields Center Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

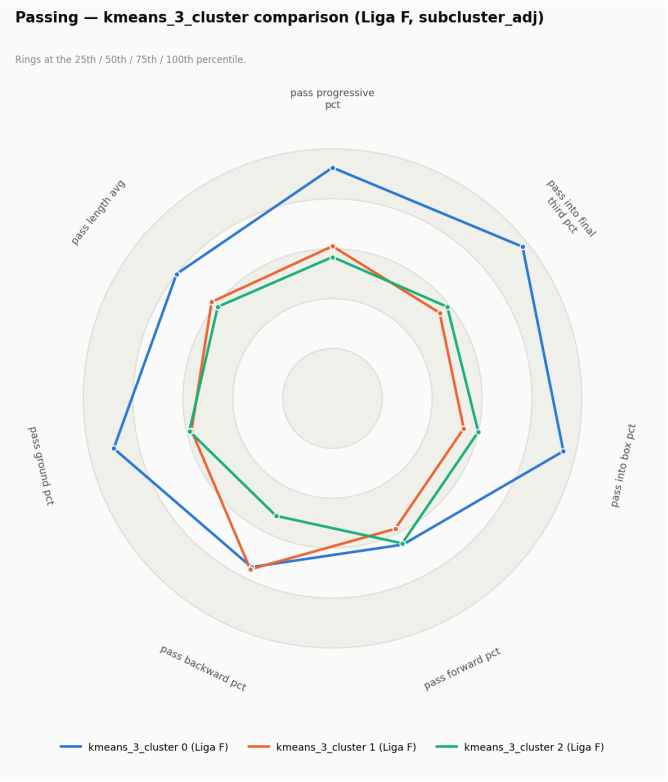


Figure 50: Spain Center Midfields Center Passing — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

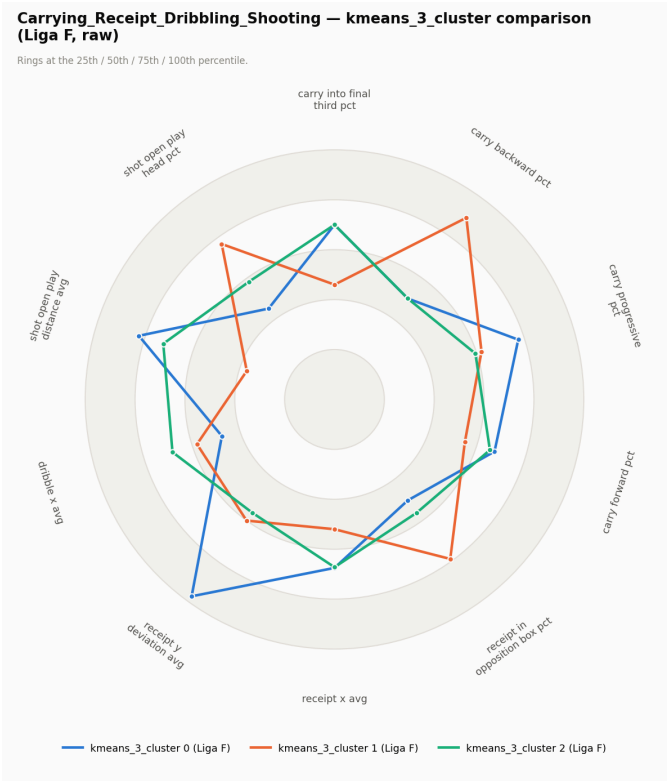


Figure 51: Spain Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

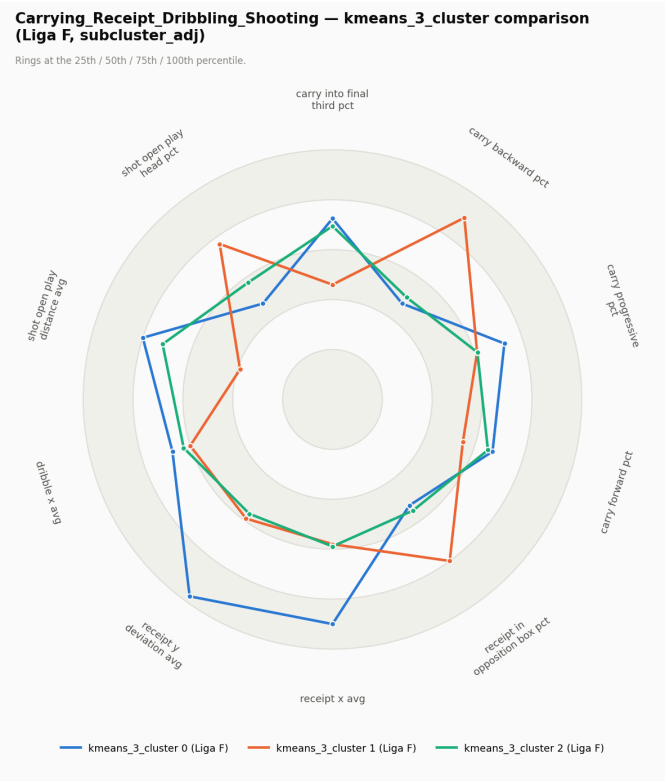


Figure 52: Spain Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

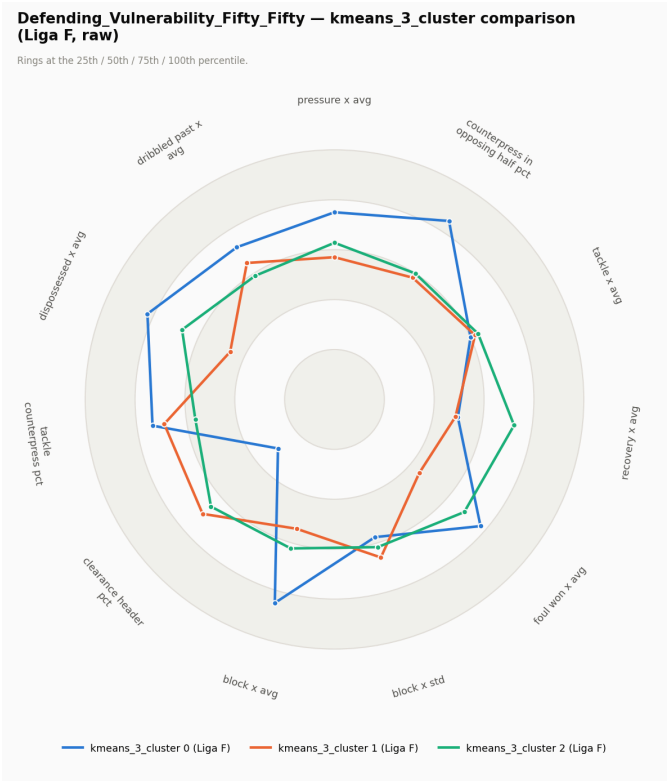


Figure 53: Spain Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

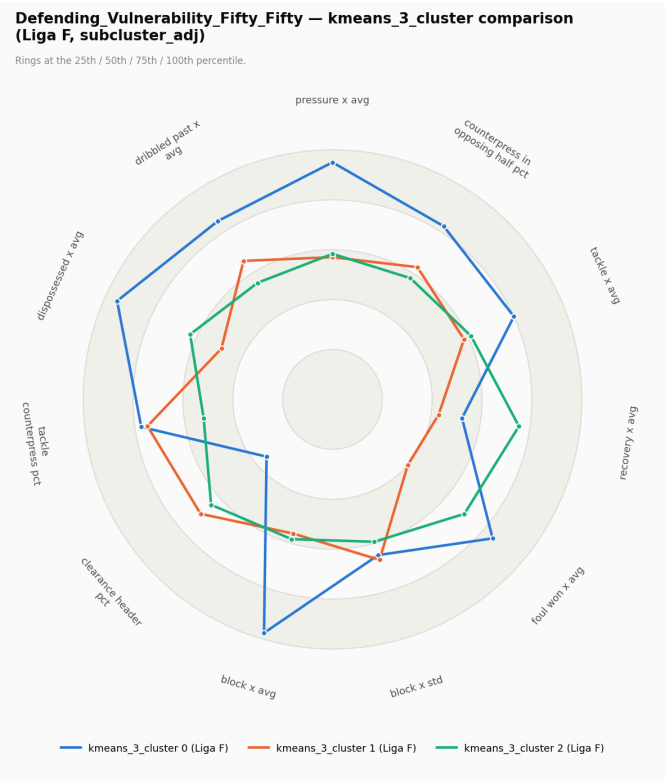


Figure 54: Spain Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Serie A Women

Passing

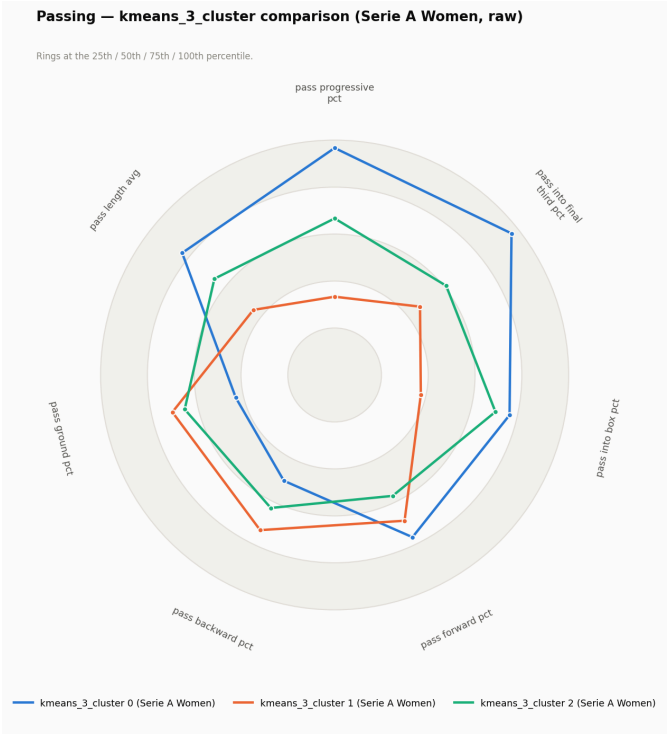


Figure 55: Italy Center Midfields Center Passing — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

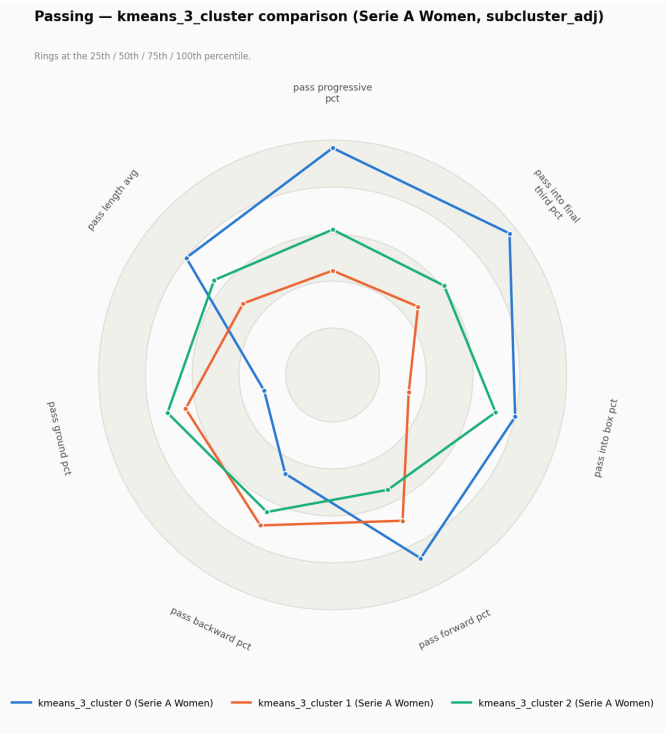


Figure 56: Italy Center Midfields Center Passing — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting

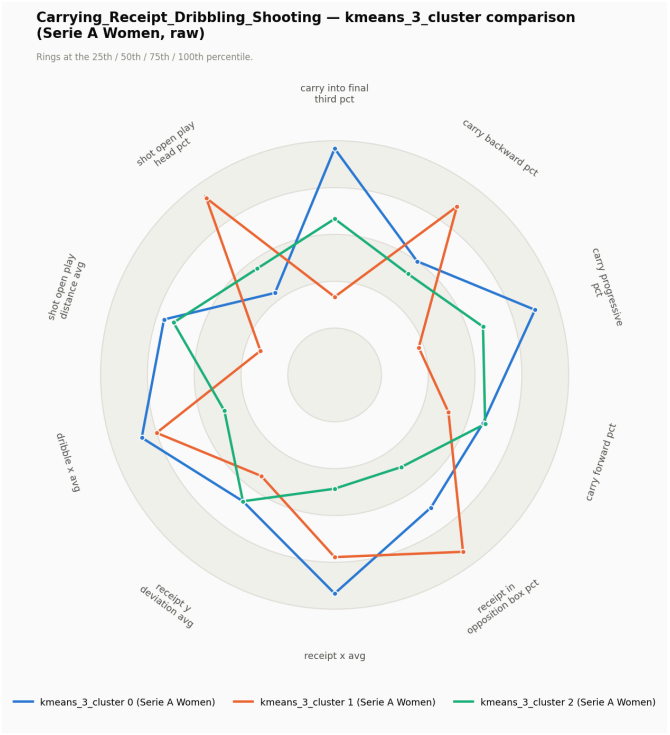


Figure 57: Italy Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

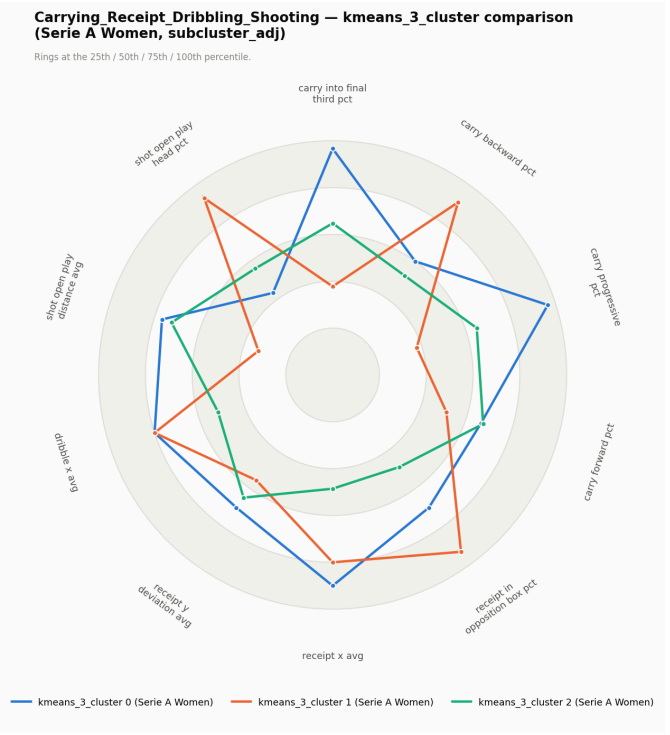


Figure 58: Italy Center Midfields Center Carrying, Receipt, Dribbling & Shooting — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

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Defending & Vulnerability

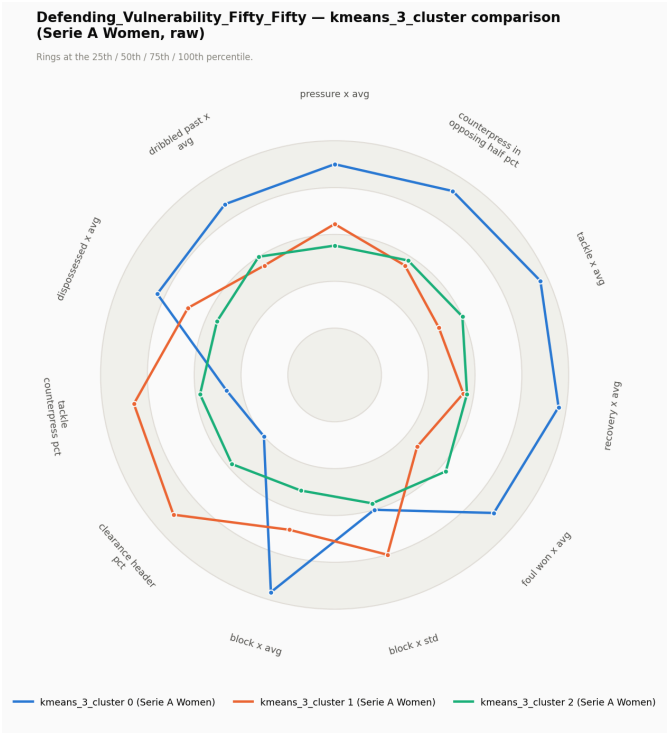


Figure 59: Italy Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Raw Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters

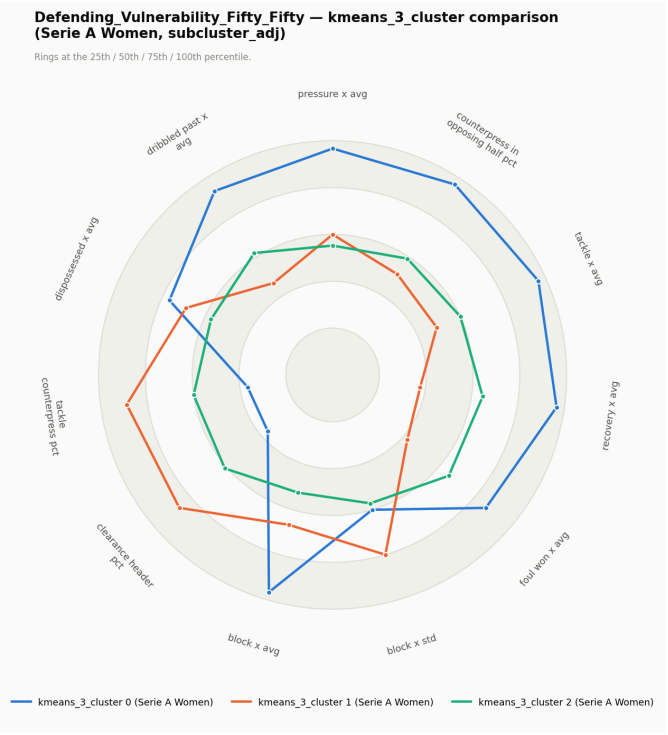


Figure 60: Italy Center Midfields Center Defending Vulnerability Fifty Fifty — Subcluster Adjusted Statistics Comparison, 3 Clusters